EMBASSY OF THE
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

No. 240 Chungking, December 16, 1941

Subject: Statement by Chiang Kai-shek in Regard to Pacific Hostilities and Cooperation Against Japan.

CONFIDENTIAL

Air Mail

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ADVISER ON POLITICAL RELATIONS
MR. HORNBECK
FEB 24 1942
DEPARTMENT OF STATE

The Honorable
The Secretary of State,
Washington, D. C.

Sir:

I have the honor to refer to my telegram no. 481 of December 8, 6 p.m. transmitting a statement by General Chiang Kai-shek for delivery to the President, and to
1/ enclose a copy of a memorandum of the conversation which took place at the meeting with General Chiang when he
2/ handed me a copy of his statement, enclosed herewith.

Respectfully yours,

C. E. Gauss

Enclosures:
1/Copy of memorandum of conversation
2/ Copy of Statement by General Chiang Kai-shek

Original and one copy by air to the Department
Three copies by pouch to the Department

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JCV/gs

Enclosure no. 1 to despatch no. 240,
dated December 16, 1941, from the
Embassy at Chungking.

MEMORANDUM OF CONVERSATION December 8, 1941

Subject: Chiang Kai-shek's Message to the President in Regard to Outbreak of Japanese-American Hostilities.

Present: General Chiang Kai-shek
The Foreign Minister, Dr. Quo Tai-chi
The American Ambassador
The Russian Ambassador and a staff member
Mr. Vincent

Mr. Gauss called at General Chiang's residence at 3:40, December 8, at the request of Dr. QUO Tai-chi. The Russian Ambassador was also present at the meeting with the Generalissimo and the Foreign Minister. The British Ambassador was expected to attend, but was unable to do so because of his absence in Chengtu.

The Generalissimo referred to the outbreak of hostilities between the United States and Japan and said that the sudden Japanese attack upon Hawaii had aroused deep indignation among Chinese officials and the Chinese public. He said he had prepared a statement for the heads of various governments and enumerated governments of the United States, Great Britain, Australia, New Zealand, Canada, the Netherlands and the Union of Socialist Soviet Republics, and proceeded to read it. (A copy is attached.)

The Generalissimo then engaged the Russian Ambassador in conversation, expressing hope that the Russian Government would join in the war to defeat Japan. He said that China had been in conflict with Japan for over four years, and that the Chinese Government would now make formal declaration of war on Japan and also upon Japan's axis partners, Germany and Italy. He said that Japan was obviously the common enemy of all the Pacific powers and that a united front against Japanese aggression must be established. General Chiang said that he hoped to have an early reply from the Russian Government.

The Russian Ambassador stated that he would at once refer the Generalissimo's statement to his government, that he appreciated the Generalissimo's point of view, but that there would be technical problems to be considered in connection with the suggestions made in the Generalissimo's statement.

General Chiang then asked Mr. Gauss what he thought of the statement. Mr. Gauss said that he appreciated the Generalissimo's expression of indignation regarding the treacherous attack made by Japan on the United States, and was much interested in the statement. He said that, however, he must refer the Generalissimo's statement to the American Government, (which he would do immediately) and receive

necessary

necessary instructions before he would feel free to enter into any discussion of the matters raised in the statement.

There followed general conversation and discussion in regard to the startling events of the previous twenty-four hours.

C. E. G.

JCV/gs

Enclosure no. 2 to despatch no. 240,
dated December 16, 1941, from the
Embassy at Chungking.

Statement by General Chiang Kai-shek in regard to outbreak of hostilities in the Pacific.

Despite the sincere efforts made by the United States Government in their recent conversations with Japan to settle by peaceful means the various questions bearing on the Pacific, Japan has suddenly launched an attack on the United States and Great Britain. This latest act of international brigandage on the part of Japan has taken even us by surprise. The fact that this attack was made while Japan's envoys were continuing their talks in Washington shows that her plan of aggression was premeditated.

The Chinese Government now holds itself in full readiness to collaborate, regardless of all further sacrifices, in any concerted military plan which Great Britain, the United States, Australia, New Zealand, Canada, Holland and Soviet Russia may adopt against Japan and her Axis partners.

The Chinese Government has decided to declare war against Japan and also her partners, Germany and Italy.

In order to make full concerted action possible the Chinese Government deems it imperative that every member of the anti-aggression bloc should consider as a common enemy every member of the Axis group. We therefore suggest that a simultaneous declaration of war by the United States against Germany and Italy and by Soviet Russia against Japan should be made.

For the effective and successful prosecution of the war the Chinese Government considers essential the conclusion of a military alliance between Great Britain, Soviet Russia, the United States, Australia, New Zealand, Canada, Holland and China with a unified command of the allied forces under American leadership.

The Chinese Government proposes that an agreement be concluded between Great Britain, the United States, Soviet Russia, Australia, New Zealand, Canada, Holland and China not to sign any separate peace.